

Growing Community Engagement, One Story at a Time

Jewish Federation of Greater Indianapolis

ROLE	DURATION	FOCUS
In-House Content Strategist	1 Year	Content Strategy & Social Media

The Situation

When I joined the Jewish Federation of Greater Indianapolis, the organization's social media presence leaned almost entirely on static graphics, lacked a proper strategy, and relayed information – not stories. A missed opportunity for a community-centered organization whose real strength was its people. The content read as marketing material rather than as a living, breathing reflection of the community it served.

My job was to build a content strategy from the ground up: one that could capture the energy of a real community, engage donors year-round, and support the organization's biggest in-person moments.

The Approach

I owned the full content pipeline — planning the content calendar, writing all copy, and partnering closely with the organization's graphic designer on visual execution. I designed my strategy around three core ideas:

- **Real footage over static graphics.** I prioritized authentic video and photo content over designed graphics, so posts felt like the community rather than an advertisement about it. This alone was the single biggest lever for engagement — audiences responded to real moments and experiences.
- **A recurring signature series.** I created **Sunday Spotlight**, a weekly feature highlighting individual members of the community — their stories, their milestones, their connection to the organization. It gave the page a consistent, personal thread that people started to expect and look forward to, turning passive followers into a returning audience.
- **Event-driven promotional campaigns.** Beyond the always-on content calendar, I planned and executed dedicated promotional pushes for the organization's larger community events, including gatherings that drew 250+ attendees, ensuring turnout and visibility matched the scale of the moment.

The Results

300%+	76%	20%
ENGAGEMENT INCREASE	INCREASE IN SHARES	DONATION GROWTH

Over the course of a year, the shift toward authentic, story-driven content compounded steadily. The content strategy didn't stay siloed from the organization's broader mission: engagement growth ran alongside a real 20% increase in donations over the same period.

Why It Worked

The strongest lesson from this year: for a mission-driven organization, content strategy and community strategy are the same discipline. Sunday Spotlight worked because it treated followers as the actual subject of the content, not the audience for it. The shift to real footage worked because it stopped asking people to admire the organization from a distance and instead let them see themselves in it.